PCs and Servers

Read-through from Microsoft/Google Sep-26 earnings

Technology - Hardware

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Microsoft (OW, covered by J.P. Morgan US Enterprise Software Analyst Samik Chatterjee) and Alphabet (OW, covered by J.P. Morgan US Internet Analyst Doug Anmuth) reported Sep-Q earnings before Asia market open today. The aggregated two US hyperscalers' cash capex grew 12%/109% QoQ/YoY in Sep-Q. Google has retained its 2026 guidance for capex, growing ~120% YoY at the midpoint. Although MSFT has lowered its CY26 capex guidance by $5bn, due to delays in third-party capacity delivery, management expects a further step-up in the coming quarters' capex. The key implications for the Asian tech supply chain were:

Microsoft

- MSFT's Sep-Q cash capex came in at ~$39bn (up 10%/103% QoQ/YoY), ~14% lower than Street expectations. Management attributed the capex miss to third-party capacity delivery delays, while expecting the delivery to shift to 1H CY27.
- MSFT has now lowered its CY26 capex to US$170bn from US$175bn due to delays in datacenter. Still, management guides to over $50 billion of capex for the December quarter, implying 62% QoQ growth. It expects an accelerating capex trend in the coming quarters, with spending primarily driven by CPUs and GPUs, inclusive of higher memory and storage costs and the delayed capacity. Of note, CPUs and GPUs now account for three-quarters of the total capex in the quarter (versus two-thirds in the prior quarter). We believe the rising concentration in hardware spend bodes well for MSFT's server supply chain (AI: Quanta and Hon Hai; general servers: Wiwynn, Lenovo, Hon Hai).
- MSFT's Azure cloud revenue grew 48% YoY in Sep-Q, accelerating from 43% in the prior period, driven by strong cloud service demand despite the capacity delivery delay. The company enjoyed efficiency gains across the GPU fleet, together with higher revenue per token in the quarter. Looking ahead, management guided to further accelerating growth momentum for the Azure business at +49-50% YoY in the Dec-Q (vs. the BBGe of +45%). The robust Azure demand bodes well for capex sustainability, in our view.
- MSFT's Windows OEM revenue was down 27% YoY in Sep-Q, lower than company expectations due to weaker PC market demand and a higher base owing to the Win10 refresh last year. Looking ahead, management guided to a mid 30s% decline in Windows OEM revenue for the Dec-Q due to weakening PC end demand and elevated PC inventory.

Google

- Google's Sep-Q cash capex came in at ~$51bn (+14%/+114% QoQ/YoY), ~8% below market consensus. Management has kept its 2026 capex guidance unchanged in the range of US$195bn-205bn (up ~120% YoY at the midpoint). This implies a strong capex uptick in 4Q26 (up ~33% QoQ) and accelerating revenue momentum for Google's server supply chain.
- Management has not yet provided 2027 capex guidance, but indicated a significant increase in spending.

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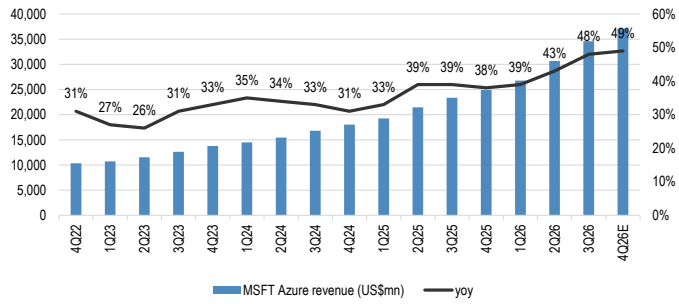
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- Google Cloud revenue grew 103% YoY in the Sep-Q, accelerating from 82% in the prior period, driven by strong growth in GCP with strength in AI, including a larger scale of TPU server sales, which is positive for **Mediatek.** Cloud operating margin also further improved to 36.2% from 35.6% in the prior quarter.
- Google Cloud's backlog increased by ~US$50bn+ QoQ to US$561bn in the Sep-Q, driven by strong demand for Google's Enterprise AI products. The majority of the order backlog is related to typical GCP contracts. Management expects to recognize 55% of the total backlog as revenue over the next two years, which implies a quarterly run rate for Google Cloud revenue of US$39bn+, vs the current ~US$30bn.

J.P. Morgan views on the PC/server industry

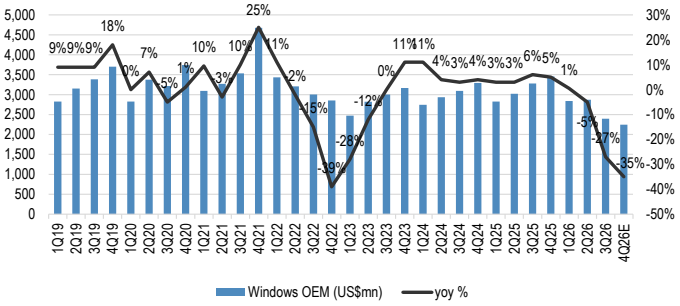
- Despite lower-than-expected capex by both CSPs in the quarter, the largely unchanged CY26 capex outlook indicates a strong 4Q26 capex uptick and bodes well for the revenue momentum of the AI server supply chain in the coming quarters. More importantly, both companies remain upbeat on the 2027 capex trend.
- Both MSFT and Google reported accelerating cloud revenue growth and improved cloud margins. We view this as positive for a more sustained capex trend in the future.
- MSFT's Windows OEM outlook echoes our cautious view on PC end-demand. We see a weakening PC ODM order outlook and OEM sell-in data, and we expect the start of a PC downturn cycle. We prefer brands over ODM given better margin structure. Our pecking order in the PC space is **Lenovo** > **ASUSTek** > **MSI.**
- We maintain our positive view on the server sector given the robust cloud revenue growth of hyperscalers and a positive capex outlook. We like **ASPEED** as a major beneficiary of a cloud server tailwind. **Lenovo** and **Wiwynn** can also benefit from the robust MSFT general server growth.

Figure 1: MSFT's Azure revenue trend



Source: Company data. 4Q26E based on company guidance of 49% YoY growth.

Figure 2: MSFT's Windows OEM revenue trend

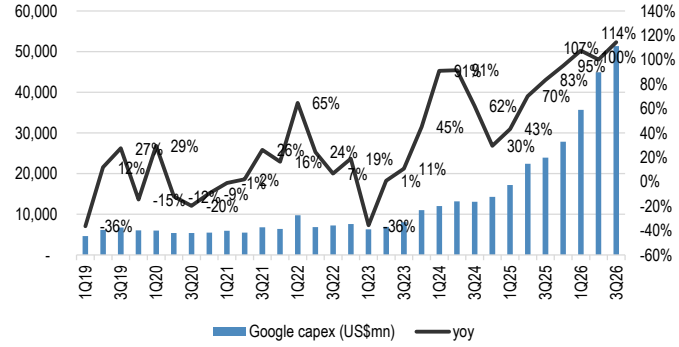


Source: Company data. 4Q26E is based on management commentary.

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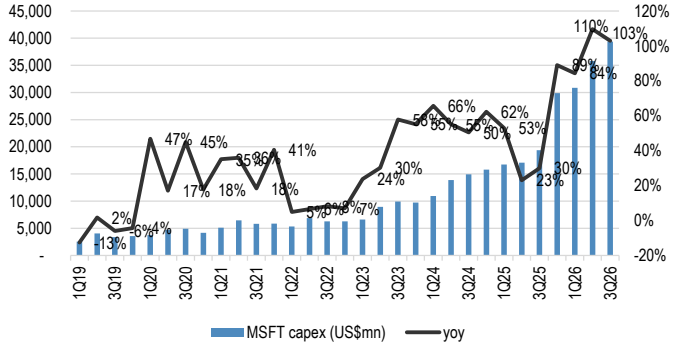
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Figure 3: Google's cash capex trend



Source: Company data.

Figure 4: Microsoft's cash capex trend



Source: Company data.

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